# الجمعة عند تيتا

*ij-jum3a 3ind Teta*

Friday at Grandma's



اللهجة الفلسطينية — القدس

Spoken Palestinian (Jerusalem). No fus7a, no tashkeel.

## Before you start

This one is about family, food, and an old man remembering. It is where you meet the **past tense** properly, plus the trick for saying "we used to".

### THE CHAT ALPHABET

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **7** | ح | hard breathy H |
| **5** | خ | kh |
| **3** | ع | ayn |
| **2** | ء ق | glottal stop — and ق is a glottal stop in Jerusalem |
| **gh** | غ | French-style r |

### THE FAMILY, THE WAY PEOPLE ACTUALLY SAY IT

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| تيتا | *Teta* | grandma (not جدة) |
| سيدو | *Seedo* | grandpa (not جد) |
| إمي | *immi* | my mum · ماما maama |
| أبوي | *abouy* | my dad · بابا baaba |
| أخوي | *a5ouy* | my brother · أختي u5ti my sister |
| عمي / عمتي | *3ammi / 3ammti* | dad's brother / dad's sister |
| خالي / خالتي | *5aali / 5aalti* | mum's brother / mum's sister |
| العيلة | *il-3eele* | the family |
| الولاد | *il-wlaad* | the kids |

**The lovely bit.** A grandparent calls the grandchild by their *own* title: سيدو says تعال يا جدي *ta3aal ya jiddi* — literally "come, my grandfather" — meaning "come here, my boy". Same with يا ماما from a mother to her child. It sounds backwards and it is completely normal.



كل جمعة، عيلة سامي بتروح عند تيتا في بيت حنينا.
تيتا بتفتح الباب وبتقول:
«يا هلا! يا هلا! تفضلوا!»

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*kill jum3a, 3eelit Saami btrou7 3ind Teta fee Beet 7aneena.*
*Teta btifta7 il-baab w-bit2oul:*
*“ya hala! ya hala! tfaddalu!”*

Every Friday, Sami's family goes to Grandma's in Beit Hanina. Grandma opens the door and says: “Welcome! Welcome! Come in!”



ريحة المقلوبة بتملا البيت كله.

تيتا بتقول:

«اليوم عملتلكم مقلوبة، وسلطة، وشوية لبن.»

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*ree7it il-ma2loube btimla il-beet killo.*

*Teta bit2oul:*

*“il-yom 3amaltilkom ma2loube, w-salata, w-shwayyit laban.”*

The smell of maqluba fills the whole house. Grandma says: “Today I've made you maqluba, salad, and a bit of yoghurt.”



«تيتا، ليش اسمها مقلوبة؟»

تيتا بتضحك وبتقول:

«لأنه منقلبها عالطبق يا سيدي! شوف!»

وبتقلب الطنجرة... طاخ!

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*“Teta, leesh ismha ma2loube?”*
*Teta btid7ak w-bit2oul:*
*“la2inno mnu2libha 3at-taba2 ya seedi! shouf!”*
*w-bti2leb it-tanjara... taa5!*

“Grandma, why is it called *maqluba*?” Grandma laughs and says: “Because we flip it over onto the plate, my dear! Watch!” And she flips the pot... thud!



بعد الأكل، سيدو بيقعد عالبلكونة وبيشرب قهوة.
بيقول لسامي:
«تعال يا جدي، خليني احكيلك حكاية من زمان.»

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*ba3d il-akel, Seedo byi23od 3al-balkone w-byishrab 2ahwe.*
*bi2oul la-Saami:*
*“ta3aal ya jiddi, 5alleeni a7keelak 7ikaaye min zamaan.”*

After the meal, Grandpa sits out on the balcony and drinks coffee. He says to Sami: “Come here, my boy, let me tell you a story from the old days.”



«لما كنت زغير، ما كان في تلفزيون ولا موبايل.
كنا نلعب بالحارة لحد ما تصير الدنيا عتمة.»
سامي بيسأل:
«وشو كنتوا تلعبوا؟»

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*“lamma kunt zgheer, maa kaan fee television wala mobile.*
*kunna nil3ab bil-7aara la7ad ma tseer id-dinya 3atme.”*
*Saami byis2al: “w-shou kuntu til3abu?”*

“When I was little, there was no TV and no mobile. We used to play out in the neighbourhood until it went dark.” Sami asks: “And what did you use to play?”



«كنا نلعب غميضة، وسبع حجار، وكرة.
وإمي كانت تنادي من الشباك:
يلا عالبيت! تأخرتوا!»

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*“kunna nil3ab ghmeeda, w-sab3 7jaar, w-koora.*
*w-immi kaanat tnaadi min ish-shibbaak:*
*yalla 3al-beet! t2a55artu!”*

“We used to play hide-and-seek, seven stones, and football. And my mother would call from the window: Come on, get home! You're late!”



عالليل، وهم راجعين عالبيت، سامي قال لأبوه:

«بابا، بدي أروح عند تيتا كل يوم، مش بس يوم الجمعة.»

أبوه ضحك وقال:

«وبعدين مين رح يوكل المقلوبة كلها؟ إنت؟»

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*3al-leel, w-humme raj3een 3al-beet, Saami 2aal la-abou:*
*"baaba, biddi arou7 3ind Teta kill yom, mish bass yom ij-jum3a."*
*abou di7ik w-2aal:*
*"w-ba3deen meen ra7 yokel il-ma2loube killha? inte?"*

At night, on their way home, Sami said to his dad: "Dad, I want to go to Grandma's every day, not just on Friday." His dad laughed and said: "And then who's going to eat that whole maqluba? You?"

# Words from this story

Food, family, and the language of remembering.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| كل جمعة | *kill jum3a* | every Friday · الجمعة also = the week |
| عيلة | *3eele* | family |
| بيت حنينا | *Beet 7aneena* | a Jerusalem neighbourhood |
| يا هلا | *ya hala* | welcome! · also أهلين ahlein |
| تفضلوا | *tfaddalu* | come in / help yourselves / after you |
| بتملا | *btimla* | it fills · ملا mala to fill |
| كله | *killo* | all of it · كلها killha all of it (f.) |
| مقلوبة | *ma2loube* | "upside-down" — rice, aubergine and meat |
| عملتلكم | *3amaltilkom* | I made for you (pl.) |
| سلطة | *salata* | salad |
| شوية | *shwayye* | a little, a bit of |
| لبن | *laban* | yoghurt (in the Levant — *not* milk) |
| حليب | *7aleeb* | milk — this is the word you want |
| ليش | *leesh* | why · لأنه la2inno because |
| منقلبها | *mnu2libha* | we flip it · قلب 2alab to turn over |

## Words from this story · continued

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| الطبق | *it-taba2* | the plate, the dish |
| يا سيدي | *ya seedi* | affectionate "my dear" (to a child or a friend) |
| الطنجرة | *it-tanjara* | the cooking pot |
| طاخ | *taa5* | thud! bang! (sound word) |
| بعد الأكل | *ba3d il-akel* | after the meal · الأكل = food |
| بيقعد | *byi23od* | he sits (not يجلس) |
| البلكونة | *il-balkone* | the balcony |
| قهوة | *2ahwe* | coffee · also = a café |
| خليني | *5alleeni* | let me · خليك 5alleek stay / keep |
| احكيلك | *a7keelak* | I'll tell you |
| حكاية | *7ikaaye* | a story, a tale |
| من زمان | *min zamaan* | from long ago · also "for ages" |
| لما | *lamma* | when (in a statement, never a question) |
| زغير | *zgheer* | small, young · كبير kbeer big, old |
| ولا | *wala* | nor, not even |

## Words from this story · continued

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| كنا نلعب | *kunna nil3ab* | we used to play |
| الحارة | *il-7aara* | the neighbourhood, the lane |
| لحد ما | *la7ad ma* | until (+ verb) |
| تصير | *tseer* | it becomes · صار saar became, happened |
| عتمة | *3atme* | darkness · الدنيا عتمة it's dark out |
| غميضة | *ghmeeda* | hide-and-seek |
| سبع حجار | *sab3 7jaar* | "seven stones" — the classic street game |
| كرة | *koora* | ball, football |
| تنادي | *tnaadi* | she calls out |
| تأخرتوا | *t2a55artu* | you (pl.) are late |
| عالليل | *3al-leel* | at night · بالنهار bin-nhaar by day |
| راجعين | *raj3een* | going back (pl.) |
| مش بس | *mish bass* | not only |
| وبعدين | *w-ba3deen* | "and then?" — also "so what?" |
| يوكل | *yokel* | he eats · أكل akal he ate |

# Dialect notes

The past tense, and the one construction that lets you talk about your childhood.

## 1 · PAST TENSE ENDINGS

Take the bare past stem — لعب *li3ib*, he played — and add:

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| لعبت | *li3ibt* | I played / you (m.) played |
| لعبتي | *li3ibti* | you (f.) played |
| لعب | *li3ib* | he played |
| لعبت | *li3bat* | she played |
| لعبنا | *li3ibna* | we played |
| لعبتوا | *li3ibtu* | you (pl.) played |
| لعبوا | *li3bu* | they played |

No بـ in the past — that prefix belongs to the present only.

## 2 · كان + PRESENT = "USED TO"

Put كان in front of a present-tense verb (drop the بـ) and you get the habitual past — the tense of every childhood story:

كنت ألعب *kunt al3ab* I used to play · كنا نلعب *kunna nil3ab* we used to play · كانت تنادي *kaanat tnaadi* she would call.

Keep the بـ and it means something else: كنت بلعب *kunt bal3ab* — I was playing.

# Dialect notes · continued

## 3 · كان MAKES ANY SENTENCE PAST

Palestinian has no present-tense "to be": أنا تعبان *ana ta3baan* — I'm tired. To put it in the past, just add كان:
كنت تعبان *kunt ta3baan* I was tired · كان في *kaan fee* there was · ما كان في *maa kaan fee* there wasn't · كان عندي *kaan 3indi* I had.

## 4 · A FEW LEVANTINE FALSE FRIENDS

| WORD | | |
|---|---|---|
| لبن | *laban* | yoghurt, not milk — milk is حليب |
| قهوة | *2ahwe* | coffee, and also the café itself |
| بس | *bass* | but / only / enough — from tone alone |
| يعني | *ya3ni* | "I mean", "sort of" — the great filler word |
| خلص | *5alas* | done, that's it, fine, stop |

**Where to go next.** Re-read all three stories out loud back to back. Then try retelling story 3 in your own words in the past tense — that single exercise will do more for your fluency than another fifty vocabulary items.